

Remembering Pat: Pat's Legacy

Sue Nokes

Pat Summitt was probably the most incredible woman or person I ever met. Pat Summitt was everything you ever dreamed she would be and thought a role model or an example should be.

She tried to live it every day to the fullness of who she was. She was a great mother. She was a great wife. She was a great leader. She was a wonderful friend, and she was as competitive as heck, but she had such integrity and you would have never outworked her. I mean, she would work you to death, but she never asked you to do anything that she wasn't willing to do herself. And again, her integrity and her honesty was just exceptional, and she just was everything I hoped she would be.

During my time at T Mobile, I had the great privilege to work with a lot of the NBA players and the WNBA players. And I did a lot with Magic Johnson, and Magic Johnson would keep saying, "Could you get Pat to come out to LA? Could you get Pat?" They respected her. She was so respected in the industry, in the profession and in the game. That it was amazing to me to see.

The other thing I would tell you, is that Pat readily shared just as she went to others to learn. And she's infamous for who she went and learned about their offense or their defense, or she was always that student that was always trying to learn and evolve and develop her game and her coaching ability and her leadership so that she could deliver better for the girls and the girls had more success, whereas most people are afraid and we don't want to share because we're afraid they'll use it and then use it against us and they'll get the promotion or whatever and we won't.

She wasn't like that at all. She would tell you, she'd say, "Well, here's what I found works. Here's what doesn't work. Do this. Don't do that."

She shared, just as much as she asked others to share with her.